

Chapter 85-5

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The Su family's family relationships weren't complicated. Su Zhe and Su Yao were biological siblings, and their parents had passed away.

Su Zhe had an uncle, but their relationship wasn't good. Years ago, Su Zhe and his cousin had a huge argument, and the uncle had taken his whole family to emigrate. They hadn't been in contact for many years.

The rest were some side branches of the family, all dependent on Haiwei Jewelry for their livelihood, and they wouldn't be appearing at this family banquet.

The closer relatives were Su Zhe's children—his daughter Su Meiqi and his son Su Nan.

Su Meiqi was one year older than Xu Qingzhu, and Su Nan was four years younger than Xu Qingzhu.

And then there was her biological younger sister, Sheng Yu.

It felt both strange and wonderful. She was clearly old enough to be a mother herself, yet she inexplicably had gained a five-year-old biological sister.

But Xu Qingzhu also felt that Su Yao's love was truly touching.

Especially after Sheng Linlang had told her so many things—she felt that Su Yao was the most pitiful one.

Sheng Qinglin had passed away knowing nothing.

But he had left Su Yao behind in pain, growing old while guarding their memories.

She appeared to still be alive, but in reality had become a soulless shell.

What Xu Qingzhu was most concerned about was whether Su Yao had any lingering health issues after giving birth to Sheng Yu, since she had been of advanced maternal age after all.

Fortunately, Su Yao had pulled through and safely given birth to Sheng Yu, gaining a new emotional anchor.

On the evening of this family recognition banquet, Su Yao also came.

Under the strong emotional stimulus, she had recovered some of her memories.

She remembered that she still had a daughter, but she didn't remember how her daughter had left her. Su Zhe lied to her, saying that the Sheng family's older sister had seen that her condition wasn't good at the time, so she had helped raise her daughter. Now that her daughter had grown up and her own condition had stabilized, the Sheng family's older sister was willing to let her reunite with her daughter.

After hearing this, Su Yao sighed with emotion: "Linlang is so kind."

Su Zhe nearly choked on a mouthful of blood, but for his sister's sake, he had no choice but to tell this well-intentioned lie.

This explanation was thought up by his wife. At first, he had strongly opposed it.

But his wife said that in the future, Xu Qingzhu would need to maintain relationships with both sides. They couldn't avoid this, so they should try to let go of past resentments and establish a good relationship. The Sheng family's older sister wasn't a bad person.

If the Su family's attitude was too unyielding, the one who would feel caught in the middle in the end would still be Xu Qingzhu.

After all, fundamentally speaking, the ones who had been raising Xu Qingzhu all these years were the Sheng family's older sister and brother-in-law.

After thinking it over, Su Zhe was persuaded.

The only people who came that evening were Su Zhe and his wife, the Su Meiqi siblings, Su Yao, and Sheng Yu.

When Xu Qingzhu brought Liang Shi in, the family members who had been sitting in the private room all stood up—except for the bewildered Sheng Yu.

But it was still Sheng Yu who ran over first. She stared at Liang Shi again and again, tilted her head and asked: "Rainbow's mama's colleague, are you really my older sister?"

"I'm not." Liang Shi turned her head around. "This one is your real older sister."

Sheng Yu: "..."

Sheng Yu made a bitter gourd face¹. "But she's so fierce. Can't you be my older sister instead?"

Liang Shi picked her up in one swoop. "How is she fierce? She's clearly very gentle."

Sheng Yu frowned: "Jiejie², do you need to get your eyes checked?"

Liang Shi: "..."

"Sheng Yu." Su Zhe called out to her coldly: "Don't be rude."

"Uncle." Sheng Yu pouted pitifully, looking pathetic. But then Su Meiqi came over and patted her bottom. "Can you be a polite child?"

Sheng Yu felt wronged. "You're all bullying me."

"Who told you to talk about me?" Xu Qingzhu stood in front of her, then reached out toward Liang Shi. Liang Shi handed the child over to her.

Sheng Yu had wanted to resist, but after Xu Qingzhu held her, her head accidentally ended up buried in Xu Qingzhu's neck.

A few seconds later, she said in surprise: "Jiejie, you smell so nice."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

Liang Shi: "..."

"Are you going to say mean things about me again?" Xu Qingzhu asked her.

Sheng Yu bit her lip, trying to negotiate with her. "Then you can't be mean to me."

Xu Qingzhu: "...Fine."

Sheng Yu wrapped her arms around her neck. "Can you hold me the whole time?"

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

This little brat's change of attitude was way too fast.

Xu Qingzhu could only respond helplessly: "I can hold you for a little while tonight."

"Only a little while?" Sheng Yu was aggrieved again.

Su Meiqi said from the side: "Sheng Yu baby, don't you have any idea how heavy you are? How do you still dare to ask people to hold you all the time?"

Sheng Yu retorted fiercely: "I'm not that heavy! I just eat a lot!"

Su Nan, who had been quiet and silent the whole time, stood up and walked over, opening his arms to Sheng Yu. "Come here, I'll hold you."

Sheng Yu sniffled, utterly conflicted.

She buried her face in Xu Qingzhu's neck and took another sniff. "Jiejie smells so nice."

Only then did she reluctantly go to Su Nan.

Su Nan was tall, had delicate features, was a man of few words, and hadn't greeted Xu Qingzhu either.

Xu Qingzhu had already spoken with everyone here before, but this formal of an occasion was the first time.

Fortunately, there was the little imp Sheng Yu who had broken the ice ahead of time, so it wasn't too awkward.

Footnotes:

¹ **Bitter gourd face (苦瓜臉):** A Chinese expression describing a face scrunched up in displeasure or looking very unhappy, resembling the wrinkled surface of a bitter gourd/melon.

² **Jiejie (姐姐):** Meaning "older sister" in Chinese, used here by Sheng Yu to address Liang Shi, even though they're not related. It's a common respectful/affectionate way for children to address older females.

